

## Chapter 125-1

At the critical moment, Liang Shi backhanded a strike at Chen Liuying's elbow.

Chen Liuying's arm instantly went numb, losing all strength. As the knife fell, Liang Shi twisted her neck at lightning speed. The knife grazed past the side of her neck, leaving a stinging pain wherever it passed, along with a trace of coldness.

But her body couldn't afford to care about that right now. She had to continue fighting. When one's life hung by a thread, human potential would be infinitely amplified. In just moments, Liang Shi's eyes turned bloodshot as she and Chen Liuying rolled across the ground again and again.

Her body was covered in filth and mud, but she couldn't care less.

Rainwater had spread across the floor of the dark chemical factory. Outside, the rain pattered down, falling on grass and rooftops, producing particularly intense, muffled sounds.

The dark clouds on the distant horizon were like a disciplined army, drifting toward the center in an orderly fashion. Accompanied by rumbling thunder, the sky grew ever more overcast.

Lightning broke through the oppressive cloud cover, tearing open a gash in the sky, only to disappear an instant later as the dark clouds closed back together seamlessly.

Darkness swallowed the light.

The smell inside the abandoned factory was already unpleasant, and now mixed with rainwater, it carried the scent of rotting wood, traces of chemical elements, and the rust of long-neglected metal.

All these smells mixed together, assaulting one's senses with tremendous impact.

At this moment, two strands of Liang Shi's hair hung beside her cheeks, her hands never stopping for a moment.

Unlike the fight choreography she practiced with the film crew, unlike the techniques she trained at the practice grounds, every move now used all her strength with a single purpose—to pin down her opponent.

As quickly as possible, as forcefully as possible...

But Chen Liuying had been training her body intensely to attract female fans, and both her explosive power and endurance were strong. Gradually, Liang Shi felt her strength flagging, but she didn't slack off in the slightest.

Even with her body feeling unwell, she still fought Chen Liuying to a draw—in fact, Chen Liuying had more injuries than she did.

Liang Shi "accidentally" kicked the knife away, and it landed not far from Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu kept her attention on the battle between the two while stretching her foot out to reach that knife.

All the blood in her body felt cold. She didn't dare blink, terrified that Liang Shi might be hurt in the next second.

This scene no longer overlapped with the past.

The Liang Shi of before had been too weak, only able to passively endure everything.

But now she was bravely fighting back, desperately protecting herself.

Xu Qingzhu's heart felt like it was being bitten by tens of thousands of ants—sour and painful. Fear and terror kept spreading through her body. The emotions she had been desperately trying to control were becoming impossible to hold back.

Xu Qingzhu kept telling herself: You need to be okay. Don't drag Liang Shi down.

Her rationality was like a tall building, constantly teetering on the verge of collapse, yet pulled back countless times.

The tug-of-war of emotions was more terrifying than physical pain.

When emotions were being pulled to extremes, her body felt like it was being pierced by needles, the pain almost suffocating her.

Physiological tears kept falling, but she didn't dare cry out loud.

Despair, helplessness, pain...

The rain was pouring down. The sounds of fighting in the distance were becoming almost inaudible.

Xu Qingzhu could only force herself to get the knife, cut the ropes on her wrists, then cut the ropes on her feet. As long as she was free, Liang Shi wouldn't be constrained.

She couldn't be Liang Shi's burden again.

"Jiejie, let's go outside." The young little girl said from within the haystack. "They're definitely not there anymore."

Young Liang Shi frowned and said in a low voice: "Let's wait a bit longer..."

"But my face hurts..." The little princess who had been pampered all her life already had a red rash on her face.

Liang Shi gritted her teeth. "Then I'll go first..."

Before she could finish speaking, the haystack shielding their small bodies was already pulled aside.

Those people's ugly faces appeared before them.

The two children looked at them in terror, wanting to run again, but were grabbed by the backs of their necks.

"I told you I heard something." One person said smugly, slapping Liang Shi on the back. "You little brat, you still dare to run!"

"Your ears sure are sharp." Another person laughed.

They had run hand in hand across the endless wilderness, feeling as if they could escape to the ends of the earth.

But in reality, they hadn't even made it ten kilometers before they were caught and taken back.

And Liang Shi bore all the consequences for their escape attempt.

Because the young little girl was adorable and cute, timid and didn't dare speak, and her family was willing to pay.

The kidnappers naturally treated her better.

But Liang Shi was different. Although she was also pretty, she didn't know how to sweet-talk people and just smiled foolishly all day.

The kidnappers called her an idiot, and she didn't argue.

She told Xu Qingzhu: "I have a universe in my heart. They don't understand."

But when ignorant adults savagely invaded a child's world, they never followed any rules.

It was like iron hooves trampling into a fairytale castle, instantly crushing it to ruins, the ruins turning to dust, not even smoke visible.

Those emotions preserved in memory were incredibly vivid. Even after so many years, they could still produce a sense of terror—a thousand, ten thousand times more frightening than any haunted house. And Xu Qingzhu's hands had almost lost all feeling.

The reason she could still maintain a shred of rationality was because Liang Shi was still fighting for her ahead, facing danger to protect her. So she had to protect herself and not become Liang Shi's burden.

Her gaze was focused on that sharp knife.

## Chapter 125-2

In the darkness, the knife still reflected light, and the blade was stained with a trace of blood.

Liang Shi also kept glancing at Xu Qingzhu's situation. To avoid letting Chen Liuying notice, she only dared to look out of the corner of her eye.

Her combat ability was evenly matched with Chen Liuying's, but her bodily functions were rapidly deteriorating, her strength gradually fading...

After briefly pinning Chen Liuying down, Liang Shi pressed the alarm attached to her abdomen.

Her body couldn't hold on much longer... She had to protect Xu Qingzhu.

This was Liang Shi's final conviction.

She had originally wanted to wait until Xu Qingzhu freed herself from the restraints on her hands and feet before pressing it, but she couldn't hold out that long. Moreover, Xu Qingzhu looked to be in particularly bad shape—her complexion deathly pale, pupils unfocused, lips slightly parted, mumbling something unknown.

As if encouraging herself.

It was somewhat like what Liang Shi had seen in the hospital right after she transmigrated, but far more terrifying than back then.

The alarm sound pierced through the long night, accompanied by tremendous thunder.

Joining this alarm sound were the rising and falling sirens from outside, terrifying in this darkness.

Killing intent instantly flashed in Chen Liuying's eyes. She said coldly: "You called the police?"

Liang Shi used all her strength to pin down Chen Liuying's arms, her legs bent to press down on Chen Liuying's legs. She didn't answer.

With killing intent awakened, Chen Liuying erupted with astonishing strength and flipped over to throw Liang Shi off.

Liang Shi's back slammed against the cold, hard cement floor. Her ribs ached dully, but she couldn't afford to care about her body's pain. She reached back and grabbed Chen Liuying's foot.

A weak knife-hand strike also made Chen Liuying's steps falter. Liang Shi seized this opening to flip herself up, standing directly behind her. Her arm locked around Chen Liuying's neck as she desperately dragged her backward, even continuously cutting off her breathing.

Out of the corner of her eye, Liang Shi noticed that the knife near Xu Qingzhu had disappeared. She was rustling about, using the knife to saw at the ropes.

Footsteps came one after another through the pouring rain. All the light and shadow between heaven and earth seemed to overlap. Liang Shi felt as if the area behind her glands was burning with fire, her bodily strength continuously disappearing. But she persisted on a single conviction alone—she had to protect Xu Qingzhu.

If she couldn't even protect the person she loved—

Just as Xu Qingzhu had cut through the ropes on her hands, Liang Shi's eyelids felt like they weighed a thousand pounds, constantly drooping downward. Her legs were numb too. By instinct, she dragged Chen Liuying backward—it seemed like she had dragged her far, but in reality, they had stayed in place the whole time.

And while Chen Liuying was struggling to breathe, she somehow produced another knife...

The blade was so sharp that when she raised it, even Xu Qingzhu could hear the sound of it cutting through the air.

In fact, Xu Qingzhu could see the trajectory of that knife in the air, stabbing straight toward Liang Shi's arm.

Xu Qingzhu's previously unfocused pupils contracted in an instant. She instinctively tried to stand up to block it, but before she could get up, she was tripped and her body slammed against the cold ground.

Those beautiful eyes looked as if they had been washed with water. She opened her mouth wanting to speak, but couldn't even say the words "be careful"—she could only let out a sharp scream.

No less piercing than the alarm from before.

Like the final wail of a bird on the brink of death—shrill and desperate.

And Chen Liuying's knife landed directly on Liang Shi's arm. Blood beads instantly slid down along the blade. Liang Shi's arm had no strength, and her consciousness was gradually fading.

But when Chen Liuying charged toward Xu Qingzhu, she still threw herself forward without hesitation.

Xu Qingzhu stared fixedly at Liang Shi's figure, watching her block Chen Liuying's path like a moth flying into flames. Her steps were so unsteady she could barely stand, but her injured arm gripped Chen Liuying's hand tightly—with such force that Chen Liuying's hand was almost being crushed out of shape.

The footsteps outside grew closer and closer, creating immense pressure.

Chen Liuying's hatred erupted. She broke through Liang Shi's restraint and stabbed the knife toward Liang Shi's neck, but because her hand had no strength, it only landed below Liang Shi's collarbone.

The sharp blade sliced across skin, blood covering what had been white flesh.

Xu Qingzhu's shrill scream pierced through the long night. In that instant, her screams and sobs condensed into just two words: "Jiejie..."

Mournful and desolate, carrying a sense of desperate helplessness.

It was also at that moment that Chen Liuying's wrist was seized by Zhao Xuning, who had run at the front. There was only a crisp snapping sound.

All the strength was removed from Chen Liuying's entire arm. Her hand was like a chicken's claw, completely powerless.

Before Chen Liuying could even react, Zhao Xuning executed a shoulder throw, slamming her to the ground.

The police handcuffs were also clamped onto her wrists.

Zhao Xuning's movements were clean and efficient—even crisper than the rookie police officers.

After Chen Liuying was captured, an intern officer who had just graduated and was on their first mission asked: "Are you also a police officer?"

Zhao Xuning was momentarily stunned, then said coldly: "No."

The other person was dumbfounded, their face flushing slightly. They secretly vowed to improve their abilities when they got back.

Then Zhao Xuning, while examining Liang Shi's wounds, said: "My uncle is a police officer."

The other person: "?"

Meanwhile, an older officer who knew Zhao Xuning said quietly: "This is our bureau chief's niece."

The intern: "...?"

Liang Shi, whose consciousness was on the verge of fading, heard this exchange and the corners of her mouth still curved upward.

She thought to herself: As expected of Zhao Xuning.

But her soul seemed to have lost its weight, and her body seemed to no longer belong to her.

As her consciousness faded, she heard Zhao Xuning's voice by her ear: "Liang Shi, are you crazy? Not taking suppressants during your susceptible period."

Liang Shi: "....."

So it was because of her susceptible period.

She hadn't adapted to this world's bodily rules...

No wonder her glands felt like they were being scorched by fire. If she had taken suppressants, would she have been stronger than now...

Damn susceptible period, making her bodily functions continuously deteriorate.

Next time she had to remember to take suppressants before going out.

She remembered the last susceptible period was with Xu Qingzhu... Was Xu Qingzhu's heat period also coming soon?

Xu Qingzhu...

## Chapter 125-3

It seemed as if that shrill cry of "jiejie" still lingered in Liang Shi's ears. Her eyes could barely stay open, her arms felt like they weighed a thousand pounds, but she still stubbornly tugged at the hem of Zhao Xuning's clothes that hung down. Her lips parted slightly: "Go check on Zhuzi..."

Zhao Xuning frowned. Her voice was cold, yet carried a hint of warmth: "You can barely take care of yourself and you're still worrying about others..."

Liang Shi heard her say: "Dr. Gu is here."

Hearing this, Liang Shi thought: Zhao Xuning really is a reliable person.

Liang Shi's thoughts stopped there. She seemed to have fallen into chaos, the world between heaven and earth a sheet of white.

At this very moment, that strange mechanical system voice sounded: 【Ding dong! Congratulations, Host—your Fortune Value has accumulated to 100. You have completed the capture mission! The Fortune Value System and Misfortune Value System are simultaneously going offline. The Host's soul and body will both return to their rightful places. Everything will return to its proper track. This body will be reclaimed by the Resentment Management Bureau for secondary processing.】

This stupid system—it only let her complete the mission on the very last day she was in this world.

Liang Shi had thought she wouldn't be able to complete it.

What was the key event the system mentioned?

Triggering Xu Qingzhu's PTSD? Or the kidnapping case?

Or the event of her glands being gouged out? Regardless of the final outcome, this event had to exist—only then would it follow the original book's storyline.

Liang Shi's mind was now a complete mess; she couldn't hear anything.

She really wanted to talk to Xu Qingzhu. She wanted to comfort Xu Qingzhu and tell her not to be afraid, but she couldn't speak anymore...

The system's strange mechanical voice continued: 【The Host is truly a good person. Your Fortune Value has now reached nearly three hundred. The Resentment Management Bureau is making an exception to grant you generous rewards: one million RMB, as well as... bzzt bzzt】

A headache-inducing static sound rang out in her mind, like someone drilling next to her ear, making her scalp tingle.

And this sound mixed together with the thunder on this rainy night.



【Bzzt... Host... body... return... bzzt...】

Before Liang Shi could even curse, she completely lost consciousness.